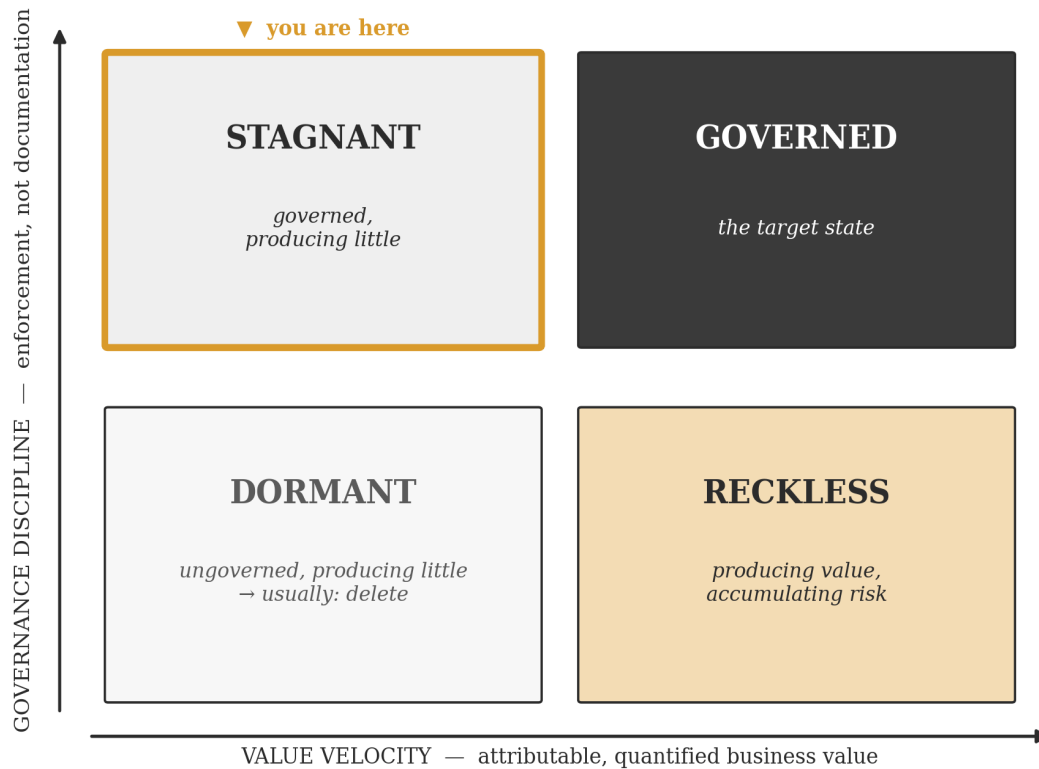


Your position: STAGNANT

governed, producing little



What this position means

Governance succeeded so thoroughly at preventing risk that it also prevented deployment. Committees, policies, approval gates, risk reviews — and little AI in production generating attributable value. This is the failure mode of treating governance as a gate rather than an enabler, and it carries a hidden second cost: capable teams facing uniform friction eventually route around it, which means today's Stagnant organisation is quietly growing tomorrow's Reckless cluster in the shadows.

Direction of travel: Stagnant → Governed

An enablement problem. The governance infrastructure exists; the deployment infrastructure does not. The fix is not less governance — it is calibrated governance.

The first three moves

- **1. Segment the pipeline by consequence.** Define explicit criteria separating low-risk systems (internal drafting tools, read-only assistants over approved material) from high-consequence ones (customer-facing, regulated decisions, write access). One page, decided once, applied everywhere.
- **2. Build the fast track and make it genuinely fast.** Pre-approved patterns, standard access routes, default logging — a low-risk system should reach production in days through the governed path. If the fast track is not faster than the workaround, it will not be used.
- **3. Reserve full review for systems whose consequences justify it.** And measure the review itself: approval time is now a governance KPI, not just a risk one.

The characteristic obstacle

A governance function that measures itself on prevented risk rather than enabled value will resist calibration — every fast-track proposal reads as a control being weakened. Reframe the mandate: the function's output is governed systems in production, not reviews completed.

Watch for: Watch the shadow indicator. Rising unapproved tool usage in discovery signals that friction is already leaking value out of the governed path — the Stagnant-to-Reckless drift happens off the official map.

What to measure

- Deployment lead time by risk class — the fast track's number is the programme's credibility.
- Share of the estate producing attributable value (the Value Velocity axis, tracked quarterly).
- Shadow-AI discovery trend — flat or falling means the governed path is winning.

Rescoring — the instrument itself

Your questionnaire result is a screening across the estate on average. The instrument proper is applied per system.

Governance Discipline (0–4):

0	No owner, no documentation, no monitoring. The system exists; nobody is accountable.
1	Owner named. No enforced controls, no monitoring baseline. Governance is a name on a list.
2	Policy exists and is <i>partially</i> enforced. Monitoring manual or intermittent. (A policy nobody can show is enforced scores 1, not 2.)
3	Policy enforced consistently. Active monitoring with a review cadence. Incident escalation documented <i>and tested</i> .
4	Every governance claim is demonstrable from the system's own telemetry. The system could face a regulator with evidence behind every claim.

Scores 0–1 plot Low; 3–4 High; a 2 is the transition zone — err low. **Value Velocity** is one question: can we attribute and quantify this system's KPI contribution, with a defensible number and methodology — yes or no?

The exercise, in five steps

Capture leadership's belief first and do not let anyone revise it. Build the real inventory from multiple signals — not from project registrations. Score every system with the rubric above, erring low where evidence is missing (missing evidence is the finding). Plot the map. Measure the distance between the belief and the data — that gap is the headline of the board report. Repeat quarterly: the Quadrant is a snapshot, and the direction of travel matters more than any single placement.

Status of this instrument

A working diagnostic from the field research behind *Govern or Fail: Why Enterprise AI Fails After the Demo* — deliberately published here rather than in the book, which stops where validation stops. The book is the diagnosis; this is the field kit. Use it, and where it breaks, tell me: governorfail.com. *Govern or Fail* launches September 2026.